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EXPERIMENT 9
Blueprint in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To create and implement a Blueprint in Zoho Creator that models a business process as a series of stages and transitions, and to learn how a Blueprint controls the flow of records in a Loan Disbursement process.

2. Introduction

A Blueprint in Zoho Creator is a visual tool that defines a business process from start to finish. The process is drawn as **stages** (the states a record passes through) connected by **transitions** (the actions that move a record from one stage to the next). A Blueprint makes sure that every record follows the defined steps in the correct order and that nobody can skip a stage. It is created on a form and uses a field of that form, such as a status field, to record the current stage.

Each transition can have conditions and actions: **Before** (who may perform it and under what criteria), **During** (the fields or checks that must be completed) and **After** (actions that run once the transition is done, such as updating a field or sending a notification). In this experiment a Blueprint named **Loan Disbursement Process** is created for the Loan Disbursement Form.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To learn the meaning and importance of Blueprints in Zoho Creator.
- To understand stages, transitions and the Before, During and After parts of a transition.
- To study how a Blueprint is created on a form and enabled.
- To understand how forms with and without Blueprints are listed in the Workflow section.
- To create a working Blueprint for a real-world loan disbursement process.

4. Procedure

1 Sign in to Zoho Creator and open the **Loan Application**.

2 Click **Workflow** in the top menu and open the **Blueprints** tab.

3 In the left panel, note the *Forms with Blueprints* and *Forms without Blueprints* lists.

4 Click **New Blueprint** and select the **Loan Disbursement Form**.

5 Name the Blueprint **Loan Disbursement Process** and choose the field that holds the stage (for example, **Disbursement_Status**).

6 Define the stages of the process, such as **Pending** and **Disbursed**.

7 Create the transitions between stages (for example, “Disburse Loan” from Pending to Disbursed) and set the Before, During and After options for each transition.

8 Save the Blueprint and make sure its status is **Enabled**.

9 Open the application in Access mode, add a disbursement record and move it through the stages using the transitions.

10 Make necessary changes to the Blueprint, if required, and publish the application.

5. Illustrative Example

Consider a Loan Management System developed using Zoho Creator, where information about loan applications, disbursements, EMI payments, applicants and branches is maintained in forms. A loan should be disbursed only after it has been approved, and the steps must happen in a fixed order.

5.1 Implementation using Zoho Creator

A Blueprint named **Loan Disbursement Process** is created for the **Loan Disbursement Form**. It is enabled and was created on 30-Oct-2026 at 11:57:50. The Blueprints tab lists the Loan Disbursement Form under *Forms with Blueprints*, while Applicant_Details, Branches, EMI Payment Tracking Form and Loan_Application_Form appear under *Forms without Blueprints*.

S.No	Item	Value / Description
1	Blueprint Name	Loan Disbursement Process
2	Form	Loan Disbursement Form
3	Status	Enabled
4	Created On	30-Oct-2026 11:57:50
5	Forms with Blueprints	Loan Disbursement Form
6	Forms without Blueprints	Applicant_Details, Branches, EMI Payment Tracking Form, Loan_Application_Form

The main parts of a Blueprint and their use in the loan disbursement process are:

S.No	Blueprint Part	Use in the Loan Disbursement Process
1	Stage	A state of the record, such as Pending or Disbursed.
2	Transition	The action that moves a record to the next stage, e.g., Disburse Loan.
3	Before	Decides who can perform the transition and under what criteria, e.g., only a manager.
4	During	Fields or checks required during the transition, e.g., entering the Disbursement_Date.
5	After	Actions that run after the transition, e.g., updating a field or sending a notification.

5.2 Illustrative Blueprint Design

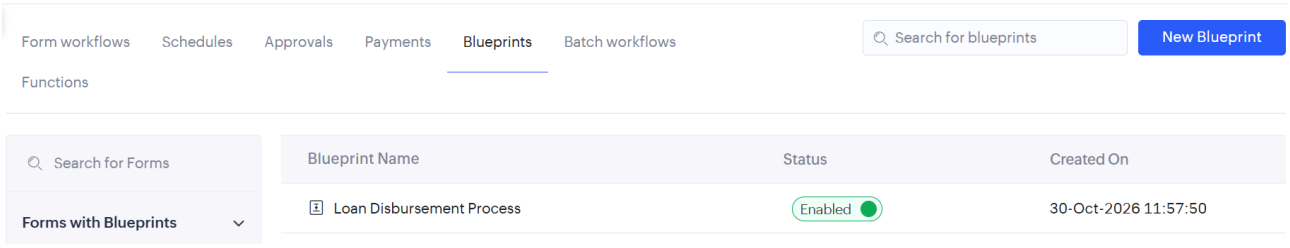


Figure 1: Blueprints tab showing the Loan Disbursement Process Blueprint

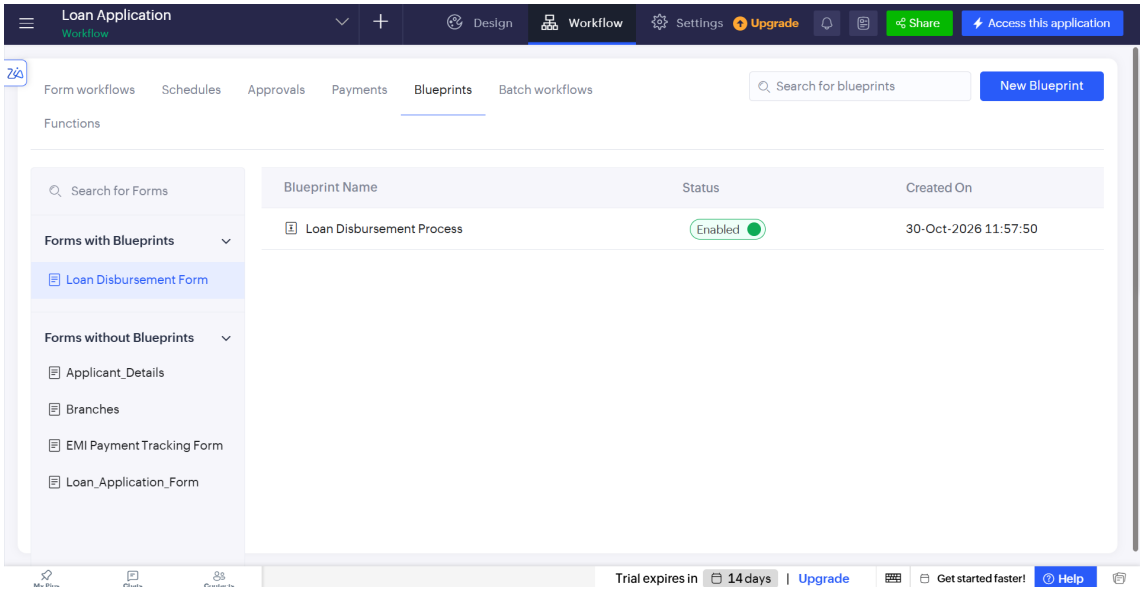


Figure 2: Blueprints section of the Loan Application (complete view)

6. Advantages and Limitations

6.1 Advantages

- Enforces a fixed order of steps so that no stage can be skipped.
- Shows the process visually, making it easy to understand and modify.
- Controls who can perform each transition, which improves accountability.
- Allows actions and validations to run automatically during transitions.
- Built with a drag-and-drop builder and little or no coding.

6.2 Limitations

- A Blueprint is tied to one form and one stage field.
- Very long or complex processes can become hard to manage visually.
- Advanced conditions and actions may require Deluge scripting.
- Records already in the form may need to be mapped to the Blueprint stages.
- Available Blueprint features depend on the capabilities of the Zoho Creator platform.

7. Result

The experiment was successfully completed by learning the process of creating Blueprints in Zoho Creator and implementing the Loan Disbursement Process Blueprint for the Loan Disbursement Form. The implementation showed how stages and transitions can be used to control a business process with minimal coding.